

When you are resting, your heart pumps about 10 pints (5 liters) of blood around your body every minute.



AT REST

When you are sitting quietly, your body is resting. A normal resting heart rate can be anything from 40 to 100 beats per minute. The rate varies with your age, but also with your level of fitness. The higher your fitness level, the slower your resting heart rate will be.

SWITCHING OFF

Your body is at its most relaxed when you are sleeping, but your heart keeps ticking away. It usually beats more slowly than when you are awake and resting. This means that your heart might slow from about 64 to 52 beats per minute as you fall asleep. But it speeds up again if you are dreaming.

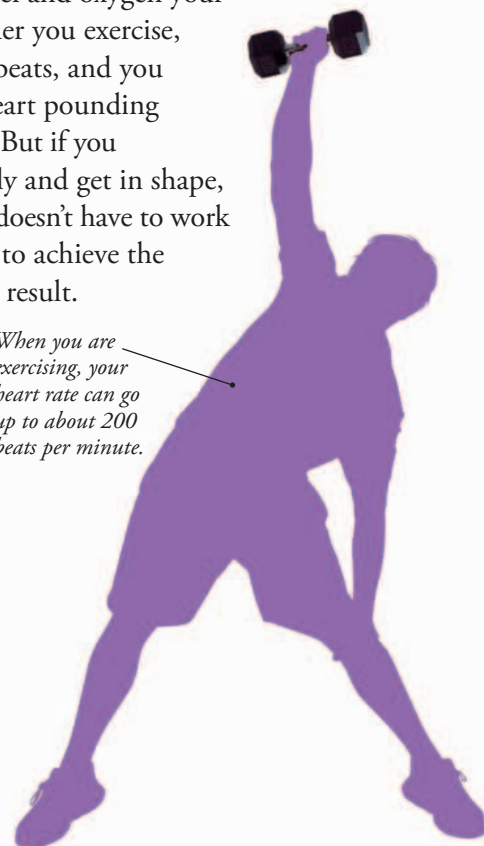
Within 10 minutes of falling asleep, your heart rate starts to slow down.



WORKING OUT

Physical activity puts more demands on your body, so your heart rate speeds up to supply the extra fuel and oxygen your body needs. The harder you exercise, the faster your heart beats, and you can often feel your heart pounding away in your chest. But if you exercise regularly and get in shape, your heart doesn't have to work so hard to achieve the same result.

When you are exercising, your heart rate can go up to about 200 beats per minute.



Even watching a scary movie can make your heart beat faster.

